

About You
KAY - AI Fashion Assistant & Recommender Feature
Discovery Report

Discovery Report

Company: ABOUT YOU

Platform: Mobile app

Product area: Fashion discovery & recommendations

Concept: AI-powered conversational fashion assistant

1. Context & Goal

ABOUT YOU offers a large fashion and lifestyle catalogue supported by search, filters, recommendations, Size finder, Body Scan, Virtual Try-On, and the existing KAY chatbot.

However, the current KAY experience appears primarily support-oriented. When a shopper expresses direct shopping intent—for example, asking KAY to show trousers—KAY may guide them toward filters, size charts, or other shopping tools rather than directly presenting relevant products.

This creates an opportunity to explore **conversation itself as a shopping interface**.

Instead of requiring users to translate what they have in mind into categories and multiple filters, shoppers could simply describe what they need:

“Suggest beige trousers for a summer day party.”

Or ask for guidance when they are less certain:

“Help me find an outfit for a date night.”

Discovery Goal

Explore how KAY could evolve into an **AI-powered conversational fashion assistant and recommender** that helps users discover products, receive guidance, and refine recommendations naturally within the ABOUT YOU mobile shopping journey.

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The core question is:

Can conversational AI help shoppers move from an idea or need to relevant products with less manual searching, filtering, and browsing?

2. Discovery & Observations

2.1 Discovery Approach

The discovery explored how conversational AI could support fashion-product discovery within the existing ABOUT YOU shopping experience.

The research focused on understanding:

- How shoppers express fashion and shopping needs
- Where search, filtering and browsing may create friction
- When shoppers know what they want versus when they need guidance
- What information is important for relevant recommendations
- Expectations around size, budget, style and preferences
- The role of recommendation explanations and user trust
- Opportunities for personalization and image-based discovery

Research Method

At this stage, discovery combines:

- Review of the existing KAY and ABOUT YOU shopping experience
- Competitor and market exploration
- Product hypothesis development
- **AI-simulated exploratory interviews for hypothesis generation**

Research limitation: The simulated interviews do not represent actual ABOUT YOU customers or validated user research. They are used to explore possible behaviours, needs and assumptions that should subsequently be tested with real users.

2.2 Planned User Research

Research Objective

Understand how online fashion shoppers currently discover products and whether conversational assistance could help them move from a shopping need to relevant products with less effort.

Target Participants

5–8 online fashion shoppers, ideally including a mix of:

- Frequent and occasional fashion shoppers
- Primarily mobile shoppers
- Shoppers who usually know roughly what they want
- Shoppers who sometimes need inspiration or occasion-based guidance
- Users with experience using ecommerce search and filters

Method & Duration

Semi-structured interviews · 20–25 minutes per participant

Key areas to explore:

**Current shopping behaviour → Search & filter friction → Recommendation expectations
→ KAY concept → Preferences & personalization → Image discovery → Trust**

2.3 Key Discovery Questions

The interviews would explore questions such as:

- How do shoppers begin when they only know roughly what they want?
- How do they currently translate a need into search terms and filters?
- When do shoppers want recommendations versus direct search?
- What causes frustration during product discovery?
- What should KAY understand before recommending products?
- How important are size, availability, colour, budget and style?
- Would explaining **why a product matches** increase confidence?
- Which preferences would shoppers want KAY to remember?
- Should saved preferences be easy to override for individual searches?
- Would shoppers use an uploaded image to find similar products?

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- What would make them trust or distrust AI-generated recommendations?

A detailed interview guide can be included in the appendix.

2.4 AI-Simulated Exploratory Interviews

To explore potential behaviours before conducting real interviews, six hypothetical shopper profiles were simulated.

Important: These are AI-generated research scenarios for hypothesis generation only. Quotes below are simulated and must not be interpreted as actual customer feedback.

Simulated participant	Shopping behaviour	Potential need identified
P1 — Knows roughly what they want	Has an idea but spends time translating it into filters	Describe the need naturally and receive relevant options
P2 — Occasion shopper	Knows the situation but is unsure what would work	Fashion and occasion guidance
P3 — Filter-heavy shopper	Uses filters effectively when requirements are precise	KAY should complement, not replace, conventional search
P4 — Inspiration shopper	Uses screenshots/social content for inspiration	Image-based product discovery
P5 — Repeat shopper	Has relatively stable preferences	Remember preferences while allowing easy override

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**P6 — AI-skeptical
shopper**

Wants control and accurate
information

Explainable recommendations
and reliable product data

2.5 Emerging Discovery Observations

The initial exploration and simulated research highlighted several opportunities to validate.

1. Shopping needs are naturally conversational

Shoppers may think about what they need in terms of an **occasion, use case, style, budget, colour or feeling**, rather than a precise set of product attributes.

For example:

“I need a practical tote bag for commuting.”

“Help me find something for a summer party.”

These needs can be expressed naturally but may require several steps to reproduce using conventional search and filters.

Hypothesis: Allowing shoppers to describe their needs naturally could reduce product-discovery effort.

2. Shoppers have different levels of certainty

Two important shopping moments appear particularly relevant:

“I know roughly what I want.”

The shopper knows some requirements and wants relevant products quickly.

“I need guidance.”

The shopper knows the situation or desired outcome but wants help deciding what would work.

KAY could support both within the same conversational experience.

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Hypothesis: Conversational discovery may provide the most value when shoppers have **partial intent**, rather than replacing conventional search when they already know exactly what they want.

3. Clarification should improve recommendations without adding friction

Relevant information may include:

Size · Colour · Style · Budget · Occasion · Practical constraints

However, asking too many questions could simply replace filter friction with conversational friction.

Hypothesis: KAY should ask only the clarification questions that materially improve recommendation relevance.

4. Recommendations need to be relevant and actionable

A useful conversational assistant should not stop at text-based fashion advice.

Recommendations should connect directly to **real, available products** and appear as visual, clickable product cards that allow shoppers to:

View Product → Add to Bag → Continue toward purchase

Size, price and availability should be considered where relevant.

Hypothesis: Connecting conversation directly to shoppable products is necessary for KAY to create value beyond a general-purpose AI assistant.

5. Explainability may increase recommendation confidence

Rather than simply displaying products, KAY can explain how a recommendation relates to the shopper's request.

For example:

Why this matches: Available in your size, within your budget and suitable for the occasion.

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Hypothesis: Simple recommendation explanations may improve shopper confidence and trust.

6. Personalization needs user control

Remembering basic preferences such as **size, colours, style and budget** could reduce repeated input.

However, preferences may change depending on the shopping context.

Hypothesis: Saved preferences are most useful when shoppers can easily **use, change or override them for an individual shopping journey**.

Persistent learning and an evolving Style Profile should be explored only after validating the core conversational experience.

7. Image discovery represents a future opportunity

Some shoppers may find it easier to show what they want than describe it, particularly when shopping from visual inspiration.

A future interaction could be:

Upload inspiration image → Tell KAY what to find → Receive similar products

Hypothesis: Image discovery could extend KAY for inspiration-led shopping but is not required to validate the core conversational MVP.

8. Fit and Virtual Try-On can remain optional

KAY can provide meaningful product recommendations without requiring shoppers to use Body Scan or Virtual Try-On.

These capabilities can be offered when relevant while shoppers who prefer conversation-only discovery can continue without sharing image- or body-related data.

Hypothesis: Body Scan and Virtual Try-On should enhance the shopping journey rather than become prerequisites for conversational discovery.

2.6 What We Need to Validate With Real Users

The next research step should test whether these hypotheses reflect **actual shopper behaviour**.

Real interviews should validate:

- Whether shoppers experience meaningful friction translating needs into search and filters
- Which shopping situations create the strongest need for conversational assistance
- Whether the two identified shopping moments reflect real behaviour
- Which clarification questions users consider useful versus intrusive
- Whether size and availability should be established before recommendations
- Whether “Why this matches” improves confidence
- Whether users value saved preferences and understand how to override them
- Whether image-based discovery is genuinely desirable
- What makes users trust or distrust AI fashion recommendations

Following discovery interviews, the KAY prototype can then be tested separately to evaluate whether the proposed solution actually addresses these needs.

Discovery interviews validate the problem and user needs. Prototype usability testing validates the proposed solution.

2.7 Discovery Status

The current findings should therefore be treated as **hypotheses rather than established ABOUT YOU customer evidence**.

The discovery provides a basis for the KAY MVP, while real user interviews and prototype testing are required to validate the assumptions before broader product investment.

This is stronger than simply adding fake interview records because it gives you a defensible research story:

Existing experience + competitor research + simulated exploration → hypotheses → MVP → real-user validation.

3. Competitor Analysis

Three competitors were selected because they represent different approaches to the same emerging problem space: AI-assisted product discovery, conversational shopping, and fashion recommendation.

The analysis helps identify which capabilities are becoming common in AI shopping experiences and where KAY could create differentiated value within the ABOUT YOU ecosystem.

Daydream — AI Fashion Shopping

Daydream is an AI-powered fashion shopping platform focused on helping shoppers discover fashion products through natural-language requests and personalized discovery.

It represents the **fashion-specialist** end of the competitive landscape.

Strength:

Fashion-focused conversational discovery enables shoppers to express needs around style, occasion, colour, budget and other preferences naturally rather than relying only on traditional search and filters.

Opportunity for KAY:

KAY can bring similar conversational fashion discovery **directly into the existing ABOUT YOU shopping journey**, connecting recommendations with ABOUT YOU products, product details and commerce actions without requiring the shopper to move to a separate discovery destination.

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Amazon Rufus — AI Shopping Assistant

Amazon Rufus is a generative AI shopping assistant integrated into Amazon's shopping experience. It supports conversational product discovery, product questions, comparisons and recommendations across a broad range of categories.

It represents the **embedded conversational-commerce assistant** model.

Strength:

Rufus demonstrates how conversational AI can support product research and decision-making directly within a large ecommerce platform.

Opportunity for KAY:

Because KAY is focused specifically on fashion, it can explore deeper fashion context such as **occasion, aesthetic, styling preferences, fit and complementary products**, rather than addressing shopping across every product category.

Google Shopping AI — AI-Assisted Shopping & Discovery

Google's AI-powered shopping experiences use natural-language and AI-assisted discovery to help shoppers search for, evaluate and visualize products across a broad commerce ecosystem.

It represents the **AI-powered cross-retailer discovery** model.

Strength:

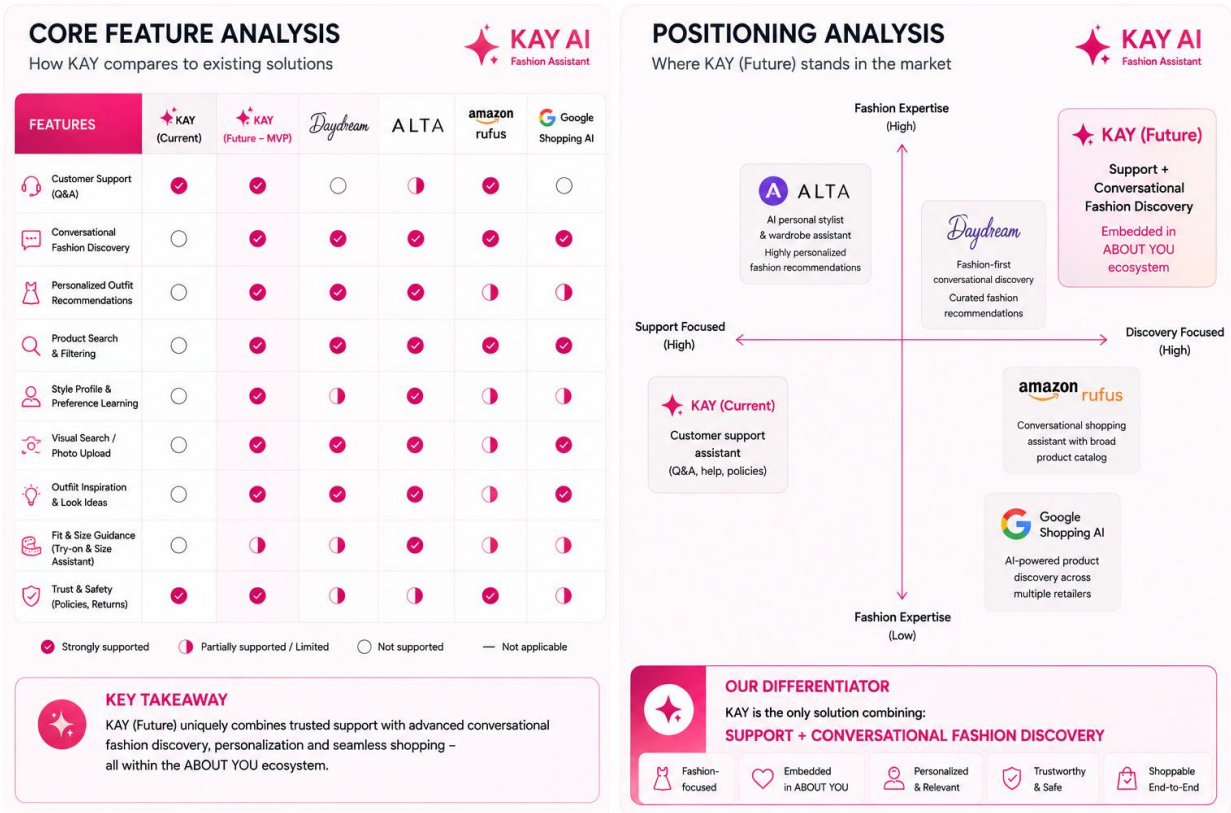
Google combines broad product discovery with a large shopping ecosystem, helping users explore products across retailers.

Opportunity for KAY:

KAY can provide a more contained fashion journey in which **conversation → recommendations → refinement → product detail → Add to Bag** can remain within the ABOUT YOU experience.

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Context creates an opportunity for specialization

General shopping assistants can serve many categories, while a fashion-focused assistant can potentially reason around occasion, style, colour, fit and complementary products.

Integration matters

Embedding assistance inside an existing commerce journey can reduce the gap between discovering a product and acting on the recommendation.

Competitive hypothesis: KAY's opportunity is not simply to add another AI chatbot, but to combine conversational fashion guidance with ABOUT YOU's existing product and shopping ecosystem.

Our Positioning — How KAY Is Different

KAY extends the existing ABOUT YOU assistant from customer support into conversational fashion discovery, while retaining its current support role.

KAY is designed around two shopping moments identified during discovery:

“I know roughly what I want”

“Suggest beige trousers for a summer day party.”

The shopper has partial requirements and wants relevant products quickly.

“I need guidance”

“Help me find something for a date night.”

The shopper knows the situation but needs help deciding what could work.

In both cases, KAY can understand the shopper's intent and relevant context, recommend products, explain why they match and allow the shopper to refine recommendations conversationally.

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Core Journey

**Ask → Understand → Recommend → Explain → Refine → View Product →
Add to Bag → Buy**

This keeps conversational discovery connected to the existing ABOUT YOU commerce journey.

Fit assistance, Body Scan, Virtual Try-On and other advanced integrations can complement this experience in later phases without being required for the core conversational MVP.

Positioning Statement

KAY brings conversational fashion guidance directly into the ABOUT YOU shopping journey, helping shoppers move from “what do I need?” to relevant, explainable and shoppable recommendations with less effort.

4. Opportunity Prioritization

Several potential opportunities were identified during discovery. Given the limited MVP timeframe, they were prioritized according to **user value** and **MVP feasibility**.

Opportunity	User Value	MVP Feasibility	Priority
Understand natural-language shopping needs	High	High	P0 — MVP
Recommend relevant products	High	High	P0 — MVP

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Show visual, clickable product recommendations	High	High	P0 — MVP
Explain why products match	High	High	P0 — MVP
Refine recommendations conversationally	High	High	P0 — MVP
Retain context within active conversation	High	High	P0 — MVP
Simple fashion & occasion guidance	High	High	P0 — MVP
Use/override basic shopper preferences	Medium–High	High	P0 — MVP
Image-based product discovery	Medium–High	Medium	Next
Improved recommendation ranking & comparison	High	Medium	Next
Fit / Body Scan integration	Medium–High	Medium	Next
Virtual Try-On integration	Medium–High	Medium	Next
Advanced outfit & complementary recommendations	Medium–High	Medium	Next

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Persistent style personalization	High	Low	Later
Voice interaction	Medium	Low	Later
Advanced personalized ranking	High	Low	Later

Prioritized Opportunity

The MVP prioritizes natural-language intent understanding, relevant and explainable product recommendations, lightweight fashion guidance, conversational refinement, and a direct path from discovery to Add to Bag.

This combination tests the core product hypothesis while remaining focused enough for an MVP.

Image discovery, advanced recommendation capabilities, Body Scan and Virtual Try-On are treated as **next-phase enhancements**, while persistent personalization and voice interaction remain later opportunities.

5. Problem Statement

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Fashion shoppers may know what they want in natural, contextual terms without knowing the exact search terms or filters needed to find it.

Sometimes they roughly know what they want:

“Suggest beige trousers for a summer day party.”

Other times, they need help deciding what would work:

“Help me find an outfit for a date night.”

In both situations, shoppers may prefer to express their needs naturally rather than translating them into multiple filters and browsing large sets of products.

Although KAY already provides a conversational interface, it does not yet fully support this behaviour as an end-to-end shopping and recommendation experience.

Core Problem

ABOUT YOU shoppers who want to discover products or receive fashion guidance conversationally may still need to translate their needs into search terms, filters and manual browsing, creating friction between how a shopping need is naturally expressed and how relevant products are discovered.

How Might We

How might we enable ABOUT YOU shoppers to discover products, receive relevant recommendations, and refine their options through natural conversation without requiring them to manually translate their needs into multiple search filters?

6. Problem Map

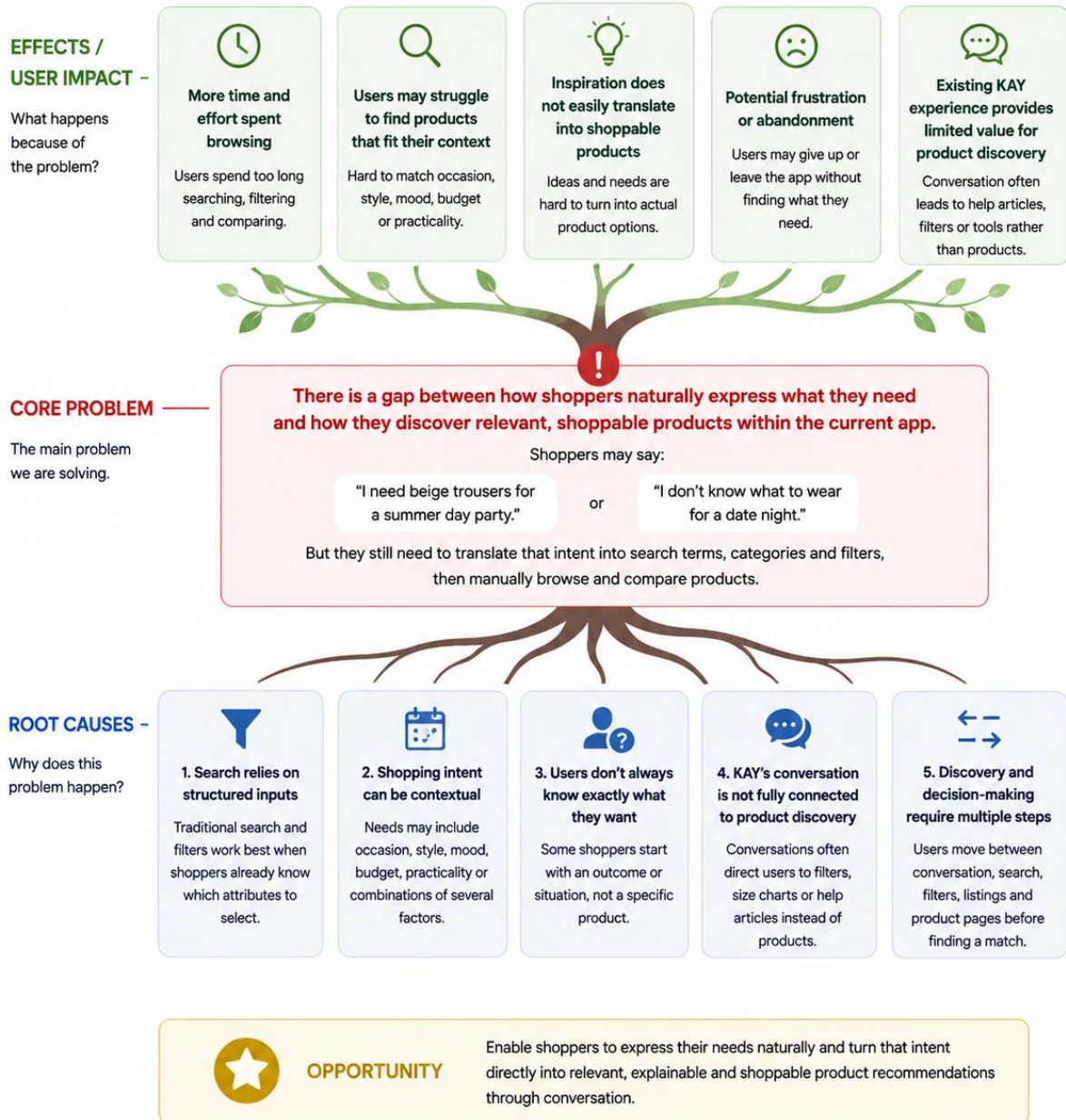
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PROBLEM TREE – KAY CONVERSATIONAL FASHION DISCOVERY

Why is it hard for shoppers to find the right fashion products through conversation today?



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User Starting Point

The shopper may be in one of two situations:

A — “I roughly know what I want.”

or

B — “I need help figuring out what would work.”

↓

User Expresses the Need Naturally

“Loose beige trousers under €80.”

“A practical tote bag for commuting.”

“A fresh, subtle perfume for work.”

“What would you wear with this jacket?”

↓

Current Journey

Shopping need

↓

Use KAY support / Search / Browse

↓

Translate need into search terms, categories or filters

↓

Browse and compare products

↓

Evaluate suitability

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Optional existing fit capabilities



Add to Bag → Checkout → Buy

Core Gap

Natural-language shopping need → contextual understanding → relevant, explainable and shoppable recommendations

Proposed Journey

Describe a need / Ask for guidance



KAY understands intent, preferences & context



KAY recommends relevant products



KAY explains why they match



Shopper refines conversationally



View Product



Add to Bag

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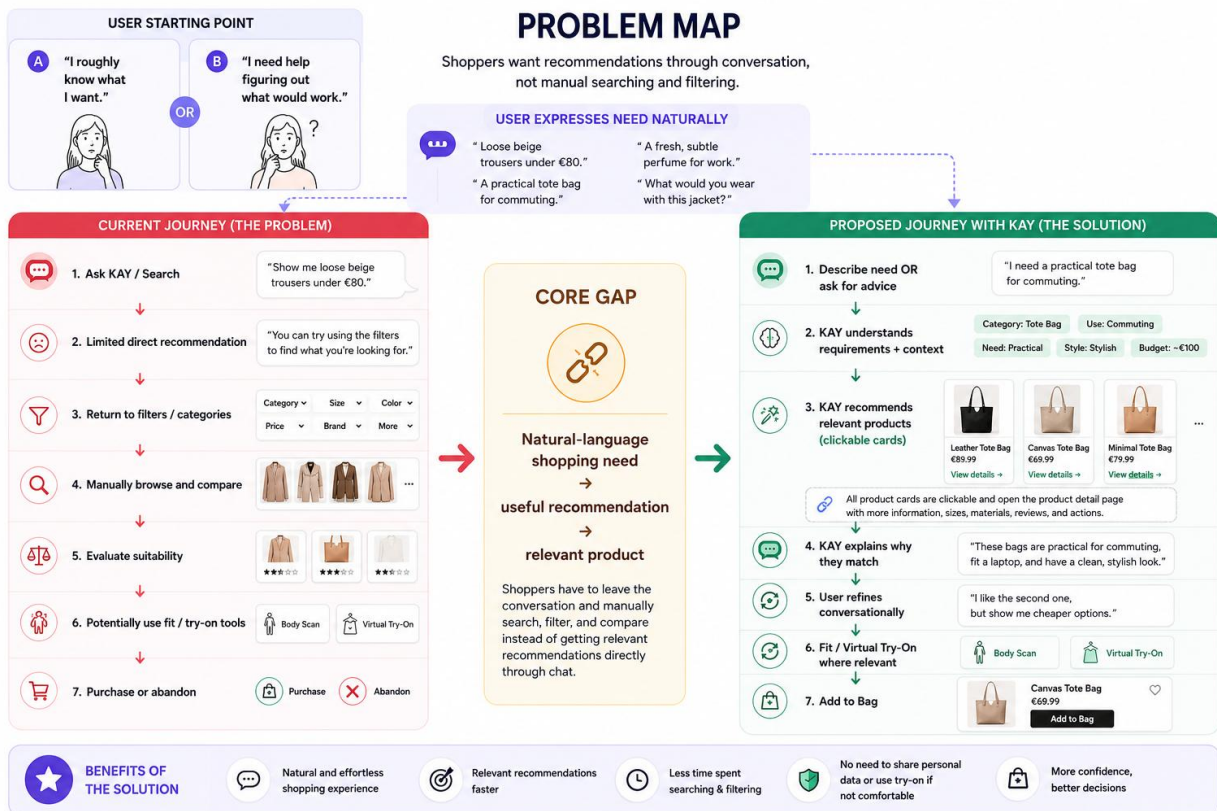


Existing ABOUT YOU Checkout



Buy

Optional / future enhancements: Image Discovery · Body Scan · Virtual Try-On · Advanced Personalization



7. Product Idea & Product Type

Product Idea — KAY

KAY extends its existing customer-support role into an AI-powered conversational fashion assistant and product recommender.

Existing support capabilities remain available, while the new experience enables shoppers to discover fashion products and receive guidance through natural conversation.

Example 1 — Product Discovery

Shopper:

“Suggest beige trousers for a summer day party.”

KAY understands the product, colour, occasion, and seasonal context and recommends relevant products.

Example 2 — Fashion Guidance

Shopper:

“Help me find an outfit for a date night.”

KAY can ask a useful clarification question, understand the context, and recommend appropriate products.

Recommendations are displayed as **visual, clickable product cards** containing product information and a short explanation of why each item matches.

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The shopper can then continue naturally:

“Show me similar options under €80”

“I like the second one, but show me something more casual.”

This allows the shopping journey to continue without restarting the search or manually rebuilding filters.

Product Type

**AI-powered conversational fashion assistant and product recommender
integrated into the ABOUT YOU mobile app.**

KAY complements rather than replaces traditional search and filters.

Its purpose is to provide another way to shop for situations where users prefer conversation, need guidance, or find their requirements difficult to express through conventional search controls.

Core Experience

**Ask → Understand → Recommend → Explain → Refine → View Product →
Buy**